

INDIA'S TECHADE

► The contribution of the internet economy to India's technology sector is expected to increase from 48% in 2022 to 62% by 2030

► Factors contributing to the surge in the internet economy are rising digital demand in Tier II cities, digitisation of traditional businesses, and the success of India Stack

► B2C e-commerce is projected to drive 40% of the digital gross merchandise value, followed by B2B sectors and SaaS

► The internet economy will account for 12-13% of India's GDP by 2030

SOURCE JOINT REPORT BY GOOGLE, TEMASEK, AND BAIN & COMPANY

THREATS OF AI

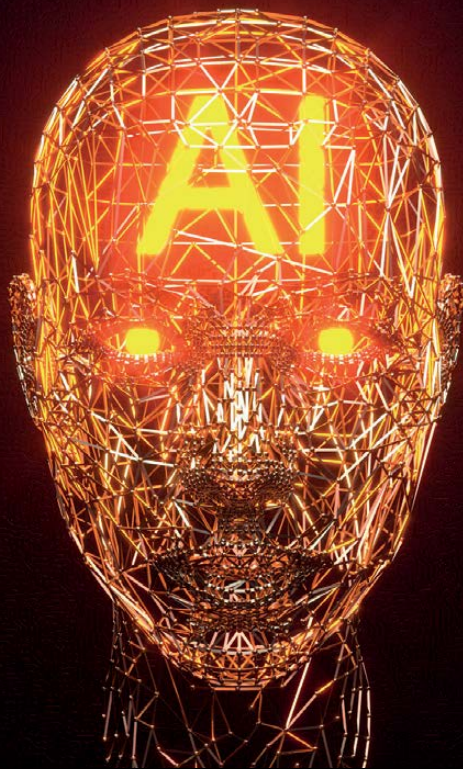
► Extensive integration of AI technologies may create a new set of winners and losers across advanced and developing economies alike

► Deeper integration of AI in conflict decisions could lead to unintended escalation, while open access to AI applications may empower malicious actors

► The digital gap between high- and low-income countries is likely to lead to stark disparities in the societal impact of AI technologies

► Tech talent is concentrated in limited markets, with the resulting knowledge gap making effective regulation challenging

SOURCE GLOBAL RISKS REPORT 2024, WEF



investigate online harm.

“What may be useful is robust mechanisms to report instances of online harm. It may also be worth considering identifying platforms focussed primarily on the creation of explicit and adversarial content,” she says.

HARNESSING AI

Artificial Intelligence's (AI) potential in transforming sectors is immense, but its adoption demands strong ethical guidelines. Agam Choudhary, CEO of Two99, an e-commerce agency, emphasises the need for transparency in AI. “Over 90% of deep-fakes online are related to adult content, causing reputational damage and misinformation. So, we need guidelines that tackle this head-on,” he says.

According to him, transparency is vital. “If you can't understand how an AI system makes decisions, that's a problem. Take biased algorithms, for instance. In a recent study, 80% of facial recognition systems exhibited racial bias. Now, imagine the consequences if these systems are used in hiring or law enforcement. Hence, we need regulations,” Choudhary says.

India's journey towards a digitally-empowered future involves a delicate balance of regulation and innovation. By focussing on data privacy, fostering innovation, bridging the digital divide, addressing societal issues, and ethically harnessing AI, India can not only enhance its tech ecosystem but also ensure equitable digital advancement for its diverse population. The next five years will be critical in determining India's role as a global leader in the digital era. **BT**

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